Although a component template is itself a template, it's not very useful if it's not associated with an index template. However, it can be associated with many index templates. Usually, we develop a component template (for example, specifying the codecs for a development environment) and attach it to various indexes via the composable index templates simultaneously. This is shown in figure 6.6.

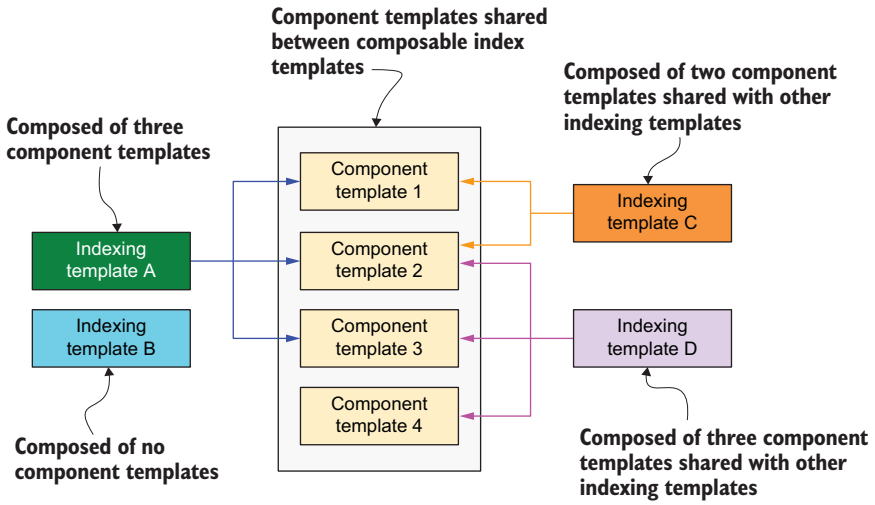


Figure 6.6 Composable (index) templates are composed of component templates.

In the figure, indexing templates A, C, and D share component templates between themselves (for example, component template 2 is used by all three indexing templates). Indexing template B is a standalone template with no component templates.

We can create an index template with no component templates. This brings us to certain rules when creating templates:

- An index created with configurations explicitly takes precedence over the configurations defined in the index or component templates. This means if you create an index with explicit settings, don't expect them to be overridden by the templates.
- Legacy templates carry a lower priority than composable templates.

6.6.1 Creating composable (index) templates

To create an index template, we use an `_index_template` endpoint, providing all the required mappings, settings, and aliases as an index pattern in this template. Let's say our requirement is to create a template for cars, represented with a pattern having wildcards: `*cars*`, as shown in listing 6.32 This template has certain properties and settings, such as `created_by` and `created_at` properties, as well as shards and replica numbers. Any index matched with this template during its creation inherits the